

# Jiaen Wu

PhD Candidate, Public Affairs

O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs, Indiana University Bloomington

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## Research Interests

Public management; bureaucratic discretion; AI and algorithmic governance; representative bureaucracy; causal inference.

## Education

### Indiana University Bloomington

PhD in Public Affairs

2022–Present

Indiana

- Major field: Public Management; minor field: Policy Analysis
- Dissertation: *Balancing Bureaucratic Discretion: The Role of Diversity, Policy, and AI in Public Governance*
- Committee: Amanda Rutherford (Chair), Jill Nicholson-Crotty, Tom Rabovsky, Coady Wing

### National Taiwan University

MS in Public Policy

2019–2021

Taipei

- Advisor: Ming-Feng Kuo

### University of California, Berkeley

Visiting Student

2019–2020

California

### National Taiwan University

BS in Political Science

2016–2019

Taipei

## Peer-Reviewed Publications

Zhu, Xiaochun, **Jiaen Wu**, and Sewon Kim. “Symbolic Gesture or Substantive Change? Gender Budgeting and Sectoral Allocations in the OECD.” Accepted at *Public Budgeting & Finance*.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu**. 2025. “Representation and the Legislative Enterprise: An Expanded View of Staff Representation.” *Politics, Groups, and Identities*, 1–27.

**Jiaen Wu**, and Ming-Feng Kuo. 2024. “How Conjoint Analysis Contributes to Mitigating Intergroup Conflict? A Case Study of Ageing Policy in Taipei City, Taiwan.” *Journal of Asian Public Policy*, 725–746.

## Revise and Resubmit

**Wu, Jiaen**. “Routinized Deference: Predictive Screening and Bureaucratic Capacity in Child Protective Services.” Revise and resubmit at *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*.

## Under Review

**Wu, Jiaen**. “From Boardroom Representation to Workplace Leadership: Evaluating the Effects of California’s Gender Quota Legislation on Female Career Advancement.” Under review.

**Wu, Jiaen**. “Does Discretion Enable Active Representation? Evidence from the 2022 Expansion of WOSB-Eligible Industries.” Under review.

**Wu, Jiaen** and Amanda Rutherford. “Is GPT a Good Civil Servant? The Evaluation of Artificial Discretion by Large Language Models.” Under review.

**Wu, Jiaen** and Amanda Rutherford. “Augmenting the Bureaucrat: How AI Exposure Shapes Job Satisfaction in Public Agencies.” Under review.

## Works in Progress

**Wu, Jiaen**, Karl Santiago, and Kyuwoong Kyeong. “Trust in the Makers, Not the State: Corruption and Citizens’ Fairness Expectations of AI in Government.”

**Wu, Jiaen**, Sumedha Gupta, Nicole Siegal, and Kosali Simon. “Trends in Buprenorphine Prescribing and the Influence of Practice Environments on Clinician Adoption.”

Rutherford, Amanda, Jiyoung Jun, Apoorva Gurtu, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Do You Dare Consider Public Service? Unpacking How Job Attributes Shape Applications to the U.S. Federal Government.”

**Wu, Jiaen** and Karl Santiago. “Transparency Mandates and Nonprofit Governance: Evidence from Board Demographic Disclosure in Illinois.”

## Research Grants

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2026 **AI at Work Grant (Principal Investigator)**, Schmidt Sciences. Phase I Seed Funding: \$10,000 (Eligible for \$200,000 Phase II scaling grant)

## Fellowships and Honors

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2026–2027 **Irsay Graduate Fellows Program**, Indiana University Bloomington

2026 **Staats Emerging Scholars Award**, Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA)

2026 **Travel Grant Award**, American Political Science Association Public Policy Section

2026 **Dissertation Workshop Series - Public Administration and Policy**, American Political Science Association

2026 **Summer Academy**, Department of Public Administration & Policy, American University

2025–2026 **Alan Brass Ph.D. Fellowship in Public Affairs**, Indiana University Bloomington O’Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs

2024 **ICPSR Tuition Fellowship**, Indiana University Bloomington O’Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs

2022–2024 **Fulbright Student Grantee**, Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs, U.S. Department of State

## Teaching Experience

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|                                                                  |                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>SPEA-V379: Performance Measurement and Program Evaluation</b> | <i>Fall 2026</i>               |
| Instructor of Record                                             | Indiana University Bloomington |
| <b>SPEA-V185: Management of Public Problems and Solutions</b>    | <i>Spring 2025</i>             |
| Instructor of Record                                             | Indiana University Bloomington |
| <b>GIPA-7008: Applied Statistics for Social Science Research</b> | <i>Spring 2021</i>             |
| Teaching Assistant                                               | National Taiwan University     |

## Conference Presentations

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**Wu, Jiaen**. “Does Discretion Enable Active Representation? Evidence from the 2022 Expansion of WOSB-Eligible Industries.” 2026. Public Management Research Conference.

Rutherford, Amanda, Jiyoung Jun, Apoorva Gurtu, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Do You Dare Consider Public Service? Unpacking How Job Attributes Shape Applications to the U.S. Federal Government.” 2026. Public Management Research Conference.

**Wu, Jiaen** and Amanda Rutherford. “Augmenting the Bureaucrat: How AI Exposure Shapes Job Satisfaction in Public Agencies.” 2026. Midwest Political Science Association.

Freedman, Seth, Kosali Simon, Nicole Siegal, Coady Wing, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Physician Labor Mobility Post-Dobbs.” 2025. Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management.

**Wu, Jiaen**. “Artificial Discretion in Action: The Effects of Predictive Screening Algorithms on Child Protective Services Outcomes.” 2025. Public Management Research Conference.

**Wu, Jiaen**. “From Boardroom Representation to Workplace Leadership: Evaluating the Effects of California’s Gender Quota Legislation on Female Career Advancement.” 2025. Midwest Political Science Association.

**Wu, Jiaen** and Amanda Rutherford. “Is GPT a Good Civil Servant? The Evaluation of Artificial Discretion by Large Language Models.” 2024. Public Management Research Conference.

Zhu, Xiaochun, **Jiaen Wu**, and Sewon Kim. “Gender Budgeting and Fiscal Performance: Evaluating Its Impact on National Deficits Across OECD Countries.” 2024. Association for Public Policy Analysis and

Management.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Active Representation and the Legislative Bureaucracy: Studying the Effects of Congressional Staff.” 2024. Midwest Political Science Association.

**Wu, Jiaen** and Amanda Rutherford. “Is GPT a Good Civil Servant? The Evaluation of Artificial Discretion by Large Language Models.” 2024. Annual O’Neill Ph.D. Student Conference. *Conference Best Paper Award*.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Political Pressure vs. Representation and the Composition of Congressional Staff.” 2023. American Political Science Association.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Who Do Legislators Hire? The Motivation of Political Representatives in Congress.” 2023. Annual O’Neill Ph.D. Student Conference.

## Academic Training and Workshops

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| <b>Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research</b> | 2024     |
| Theoretical Modeling for the Social and Behavioral Sciences          | Michigan |

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|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| <b>Institute for Political Methodology, Academia Sinica</b> | 2020   |
| Causal Inference                                            | Taipei |

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|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>Democracy Camp, University of California, Berkeley</b> | 2020       |
| Government and Philanthropy Interviews                    | California |

## Methods and Software

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Causal inference; conjoint experiments; survey experiments; large-scale administrative data; text-as-data; R; Stata; Python; LaTeX.

## Professional and University Service

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Referee: *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*, *Public Management Review*, and *International Journal of Public Sector Management*.

President, O’Neill Ph.D. Student Association, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024–2025.

## Professional Memberships

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Public Management Research Association; Midwest Political Science Association; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management.